

Reproducibility

Reproducible Research

Open Research in the Digital Humanities

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What Does Reproducibility Mean in Digital Humanities?

- Reproducibility means making the research process transparent and accessible enough for another researcher to inspect, understand, and, where possible, repeat or extend it.
- It does not mean that every humanities project must produce exactly the same interpretation.
- Digital Humanities research often combines computational procedures with source criticism, contextual knowledge, and interpretation.
- Reproducibility therefore concerns how the corpus, data, categories, methods, and interpretations were constructed in a particular research.

Reproducibility Must Be Adapted to the Humanities

Humanities corpora are often historically situated, semantically complex, incomplete, and interpretive, so reproducing a computational procedure does not automatically reproduce the research. Reproducibility should include three dimensions:

Procedural reproducibility

Others can follow the documented procedure — the steps, code, software, parameters and workflow — from source material to result.

Data reproducibility

Others can inspect and, where possible, reconstruct the dataset: its sources, provenance, selection criteria, versions, structure, transformations and uncertain information.

Interpretive explainability

Others can explain how data, method and results support the argument — why sources and procedures were chosen, how findings were interpreted, and what limitations applied.

Together, these dimensions help other researchers understand what was done, assess the decisions that shaped the research, and respond to it from their own positions.

References for further reading:

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